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COMMON EUROPEAN DATA SPACE FOR CULTURAL HERITAGE

Annual Report 2024/2025

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Consortium partners

The common European data space for cultural heritage is deployed by a consortium of 19 partners, coordinated by the Europeana Foundation.

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AIT Austrian Institute of Technology – Tomorrow Today

Archives Portal Europe

Time Machine

carare

datoptron

EuroClio – Inspiring History and Citizenship Educators

Capgemini

DARIAH-EU – Digital Research Infrastructure for the Arts and Humanities

European Schoolnet

inception – A START-UP COMPANY

PHOTOCONSORTIUM

SOUND & VISION

qi

Facts & Files – Think History!

European Fashion Heritage Association

Michael Culture Association

PSNC

DFF – Deutsches Filminstitut Filmmuseum

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Foreword

The common European data space for cultural heritage has completed its third year of deployment, and it is time to reflect on the achievements of the past 12 months, which ensure that the data space remains a space for interoperability, innovation and inspiration. Its cutting-edge infrastructure, high-quality data offer, enriching capacity building resources and engaging digital services provide exciting opportunities for the contribution and reuse of digital cultural heritage data by Europe's professionals, citizens and institutions.

There are many accomplishments to be proud of in this past year of work. We advanced the development of a persistent and reliable unique identification system that enables interoperability with other data spaces and initiatives, and grew our API offer to boost reuse by new and existing audiences. We increased the amount of high quality, usable and accessible data in the data space to diversify our data offer, and gained a better understanding of the dilemmas and opportunities presented by Artificial Intelligence (AI), ensuring that the data space stays at the forefront of the European and global AI debate. We enjoyed lively engagement with our colleagues from Member States to ensure their active and continued contribution, and offered inspiring events and training programmes that support networking and capacity building for professionals across Europe. We developed attractive activities for educators, researchers, creatives and tourists and inspired audiences with our digital storytelling. Ultimately, we created many new opportunities for cultural heritage institutions and the sector to benefit from - and contribute to - the data space.

This work was made possible through the crucial support of the European Commission and Member States, as well as the ongoing collaboration of the three bodies of the Europeana Initiative (EI) - the Europeana Foundation (EF), Europeana Network Association (ENA) and Europeana Aggregators' Forum (EAF) - and partners from the data space consortium. In Y3, we also progressed our fruitful relationships across the

wider data space ecosystem through our involvement with the Data Space Support Centre (DSSC) and other data spaces such as the European Tourism Data Space. And we continued to partner and cooperate with other major digital heritage initiatives like ECHOES, the European Heritage Hub or Time Machine, to name but a few. Through these partnerships, projects and initiatives, we work towards a strengthened and competitive European digital cultural heritage landscape, and support the contribution of cultural heritage to the green, digital and social transformation of Europe.

We hope that you are inspired by work highlighted by this annual report, and motivated to contribute to, and benefit from the data space as we enter its fourth year. We thank all of our staff, colleagues, partners and collaborators for your vital contributions.

Harry Verwayen, General Director of the Europeana Foundation

Introduction

The common European data space for cultural heritage is the flagship initiative of the European Commission to accelerate the digital transformation of Europe's cultural sector. The data space builds on the Europeana Digital Service Infrastructure (Europeana DSI) and the Europeana Strategy 2020-2025.

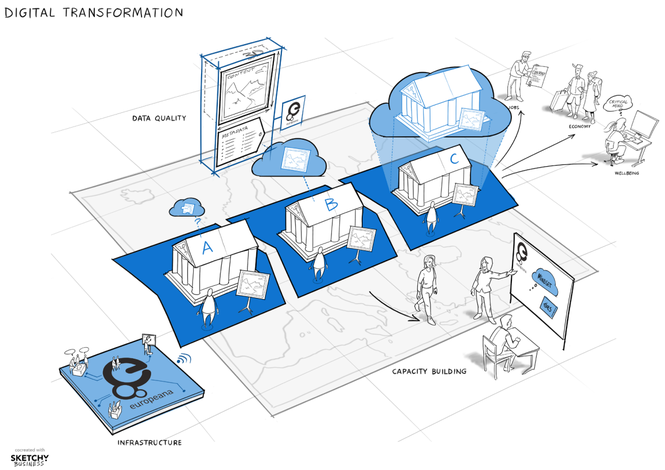
Work to deploy the data space is led by the Europeana Foundation (EF) in collaboration with a consortium of 18 partners from nine EU countries. The work of the consortium is supported by the Europeana Network Association (ENA), a strong and democratic community with over 5,700 experts working in the field of digital heritage, and the Europeana Aggregators' Forum (EAF), the network of national, domain and thematic aggregators who support cultural institutions providing data. Collaboratively, EF, ENA and EAF form the Europeana Initiative as the steward of the data space. The data space is overseen by the Member States in the framework of the Commission Expert Group on the common European data space for cultural heritage (CEDCHE).

Deployment and maintenance of the data space is organised in four strands of work:

1. Development and operation of the data space infrastructure
2. Integration of high-quality data
3. Capacity building and fostering reuse
4. Digital services for the public.

This annual report describes work carried out under the data space from 1 Sep 2024 (M25) until 31 Aug 2025 (M36) based on the implementation plan (PM. Implementation plan M24). This time period is referred to as

Year 3 (Y3) throughout the report. It picks out the main developments and highlights from this time period, with more detailed reporting available in periodic reporting. The report also includes details of budget and realisation, as well as integrations of data space supporting projects. The report is written from the point of view of the Europeana DS consortium ("we") unless specified. Please see the glossary available on Europeana Pro for more formal definitions of frequently used terms.



Digital transformation. Sketchy Business. 2023. CC-BY-SA

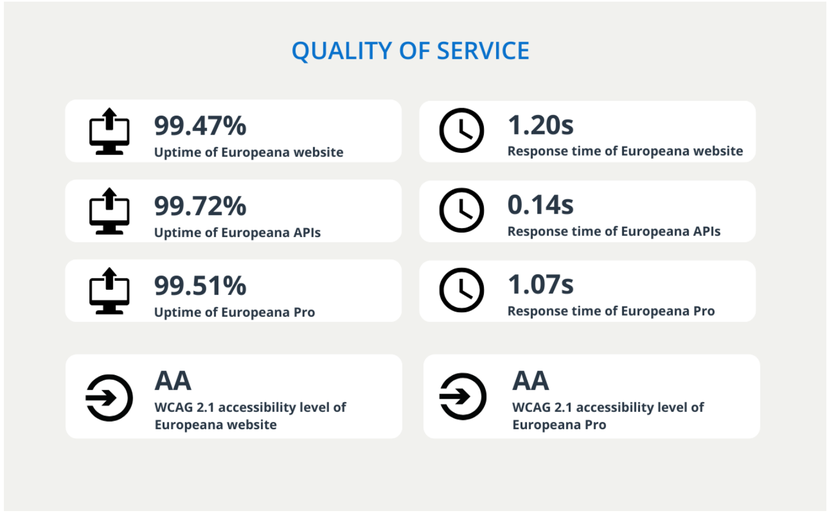
Data space infrastructure

In the third year of data space deployment, we provided a reliable data space infrastructure and quality of service while fostering innovation, interoperability and compliance with other data spaces.

Data space infrastructure and quality of services

We extended and maintained the Europeana and Europeana Pro websites, alongside our APIs and Metis aggregation systems (the data space's four main digital products). They were available 24/7 with a high uptime and a low response time, thanks to our support for the underlying infrastructure, which hosts, monitors and recovers systems.

Work on the Metis Suite saw significant progress towards the integration of a new processing engine, ensuring that our data processing components can serve their purpose for many years to come. This included preparing the Sandbox to work with the engine and doing the same with eCloud. We made updates to support v3 of the Record API which follow today's standards and best practices for API design and reduce the learning curve for new API customers, thus fostering reuse. We released a new production-ready set-up for SPARQL that will improve performance and scalability of the service, with a refreshed console that will make it easier for users to discover data and explore connections between Europeana data and outside data sources. Finally, we migrated and started hosting Rightsstatements.org on EF infrastructure.



Average numbers for quality of service of Europeana products (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. Aug 2025. CC BY-SA

Interoperability with the ecosystem of cultural heritage initiatives

In the past year, we have innovated our data space infrastructure to make it more interoperable within the data space ecosystem. We have focused in particular on persistent identifiers (PIDs), working towards a persistent and reliable unique identification system for the data space. Integrating feedback from across the sector and the EAF, we published and promoted the Policy for persistent identifiers, and designed a first public draft of a Europeana Data Model (EDM) profile, which specifies how persistent identifiers and information about them can be recorded in the EDM data contributed by providers. We also implemented a new deduplication and redirection mechanism for metadata records in the Metis aggregation pipeline which uses any PIDs available in the data. This mechanism will operate next to existing mechanisms for deduplication.

A natural extension of this idea of data persistence is the new functionality of tombstones for deleted records: a skeleton version of data designed to signal the deletion while retaining enough information to identify the item for people who still have a reference to it. We released Tombstone item pages, which are now shown to users instead of actual item pages when those item pages have been unpublished. Prior to this release, those item pages would resolve to a 404 page so the user would not know which item was unpublished. The Tombstone pages solve this issue by preserving the item metadata and thumbnail image, providing clarity for users.

We made advances in data exchange and discovery within the data space, in particular around our APIs. We migrated and expanded the registration and management functionalities of API keys, moving the API key registration form from Europeana Pro to Europeana.eu and making this functionality available exclusively to registered users. This feature was integrated with user accounts to minimise the amount of information required during registration for Europeana services and to simplify API key management.

We also introduced a distinction between Personal API keys (for individual experimentation and data analysis) and Project API keys (for active projects which require higher usage limits and enhanced features). To ensure that current keyholders' keys were migrated into this new service, we ran a campaign to support them to register for a Europeana account, which received a positive response and allowed us to go live with the new service at the end of March.

Another highlight of Y3 was the redesign of the Search API, based on historic feedback and a round of new internal surveys and interviews. From this feedback, we shaped use cases for the design and implementation of the new Search API v3, for which a first Proof of Concept has been developed and is ready for alpha testing with EF staff.

With input from the EAF we developed a first draft of a data exchange strategy for the data space. The data exchange strategy is structured around three key priorities:

Priority 1: Build a comprehensive catalogue to reference and provide access to source and institutional data; so far, metadata describing individual cultural heritage objects using specific frameworks is collected;

Priority 2: Develop decentralised data exchange mechanisms that preserve data sovereignty and control for data providers;

Priority 3: Enable audiences to easily access and engage with cultural heritage data (including data pipelines with the broader data space ecosystem).

The development of these priorities has been already activated in different ways in Y3.

We moved forward with our efforts to develop an MVP for data harvesting using LOD/SPARQL, specifically for the use case of the Dutch National Aggregator. We made the protocol more generic so it can serve the requirements of more data providers and aggregators and support the exchange of data not just for harvesting data into Europeana.eu, but for data exchange between any data space participants.

We continued to support interoperability and technological innovation through our involvement with the Data Space Support Centre (DSSC), the ECHOES project and other data spaces such as the European Tourism Data Space through the DEPLOYTOUR project. To achieve high levels of standardisation and interoperability, we followed the development of the SIMPL-open solution and maintained the Europeana Data Model (EDM) as a cornerstone for semantic interoperability within the data space ecosystem.
We established a first prototype pipeline between the data space and Time Machine to enable data exchange by both initiatives.

A data space mapping to the DSSC blueprint and a maturity assessment using the DSSC's maturity model assessed the capabilities and possibilities for evolution of the data space for cultural heritage (including key concepts like data sovereignty, interoperability, trust, and governance). Also crucial was the input of the established ENA EuropeanaTech community as well as various Working Groups, Committees and Task Forces like the Data Quality Committee.



Mosolygó vendéglátós tanulók csoportképe by Bauer Sándor, fényképész - 1968 - Fortepan, Hungary - CC BY-SA.

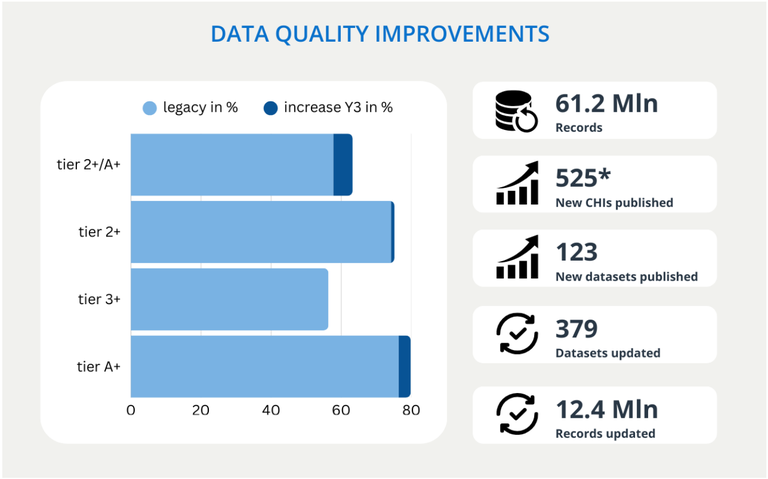
High-quality data

In line with the objectives of the European Commission's recommendation on a common European data space for cultural heritage (2021), in Y3 we continued to increase high quality, usable and accessible data in the data space, with particular attention given to 3D. We expanded data products and services within the data space and worked on automated approaches to address data quality issues at scale.

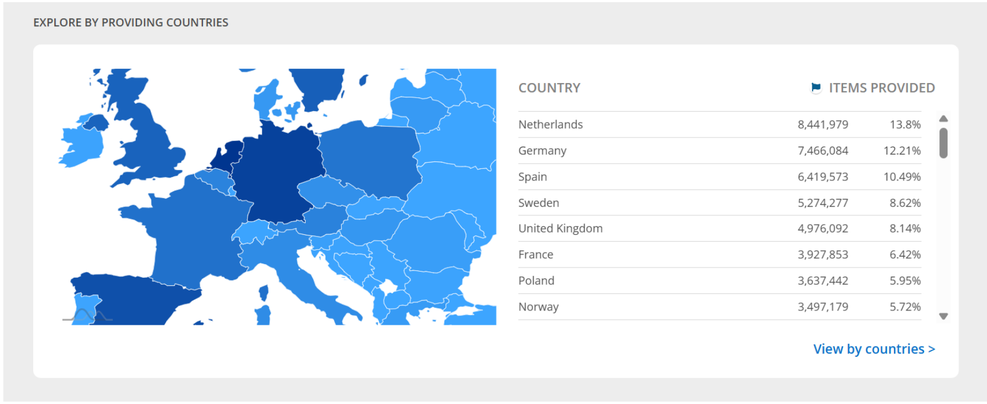
Reusable data in line with the Recommendations 2021

In Y3, we raised the quality of the data available on Europeana.eu through data cleaning and improvements, and by ingesting new, high-quality data, with a focus on 3D. These achievements were supported by data governance frameworks and documentation, Working Groups and Communities, enhanced tools and services and strong engagement with aggregators and data partners.

Europeana.eu currently offers access to over 60 million items. This is almost 3 million items more than in Aug 2024, an 5% increase. In Y3, data quality updates affected almost 12.4 million records and 379 datasets (including newly created and updated data). The updates and ingestion of new records as well as the depublication of low-quality records led to a quality improvement of the data available on Europeana.eu, including a 5.1 million records increase in Tier 2+/Tier A+ data (63% out of total in Aug 2025), a 0.96% increase for Tier 2+ (75.17% out of total), a 0.21% decrease for Tier 3+ (56.34% out of total), and a 3.43% increase for Tier A+ (79.82% out of total).



Average numbers for quality of service of Europeana products (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. Aug 2025. CC BY-SA



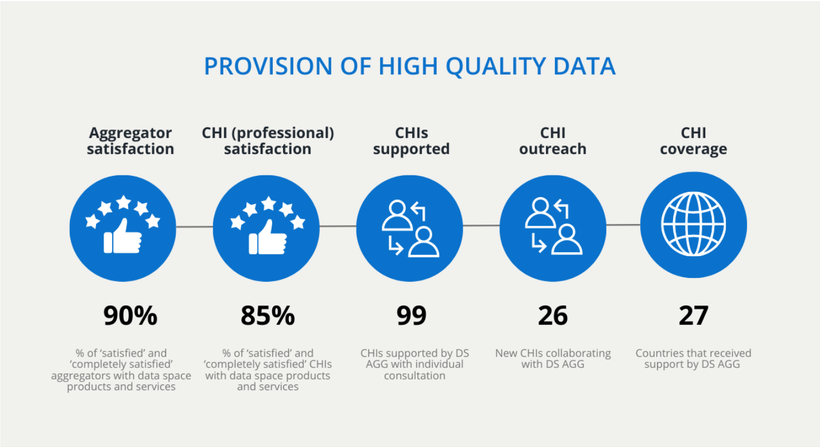
Countries with the highest contributions in the Europeana repository. Europeana Foundation. August 2025. CC BY-SA. More details on country-related data can be explored in the Data Statistics Dashboard.

In Y3, we published collections from new cultural heritage institutions on Europeana.eu and new datasets, including, for example, data from the Västernorrlands Museum via SOCH in Sweden and the Malta Maritime Museum via Heritage Malta. We engaged with 120 institutions using the 'Share your collections' page on Europeana.eu. Data was aggregated from across Member States, with the graph below showing the division of data in the Europeana repository by top represented countries.

In Y3, the total number of high-quality 3D items (tier 2+/A+) published on the Europeana website increased from 4,792 to 5,179 (8.1% increase, 387 items), with the largest contributions made by the Share3D platform. Two further highlights of 3D-related work include the implementation of selected components of the EDM profile for 3D in the infrastructure, enabling more ways to represent and share 3D digitised cultural heritage collections; and developing recommendations for a new tier system for 3D content based on actual use cases.

* Disclaimer: It is a total of 525 CHIs that our systems count as new data providers. However, not all of them are really new data providers. For many years the actual name of the CHI was hidden in other EDM fields and it is due to a focussed effort to improve the data that we now have them all correctly mapped. It is not possible to know what CHIs were newly added to the data during the update and what CHIs were already present but hidden in an older version of the dataset.

Supporting data partners is crucial to making cultural heritage data available and reusable. In Y3, DS AGG collaborated with 26 new CHIs and supported 99 cultural heritage institutions from 27 countries with one-to-one support, feedback and advice on how to improve data quality and solve data modelling problems. Aggregators helped data partners to fix (broken) links; work with IIIF; improve or update mappings (for example, by adding vocabulary terms to enrich metadata); analyse their data using the Data Statistics Dashboard; and test mappings and quality improvements using the Metis Sandbox. Aggregators supported institutions in finding sustainable aggregation routes.



Aggregators' and CHIs' satisfaction and collaboration with the data space (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. August 2025. CC BY-SA

We also supported data partners with enhanced tools and services to enable efficient data acquisitions and improvements. Authorisation and single sign-on functionalities were implemented in the Metis Suite and MINT, which were both further integrated towards a single data pipeline, providing an improved and more personalised experience for users. The curation of institution pages on Europeana.eu (e.g. TopFoto, Binnenschifffahrts-Museum Oderberg) also helped to engage institutions by allowing them to bring their collection highlights to the top of the page and better curate their presence, supporting especially smaller organisations to have a web presence without having to maintain their own website.

To understand their experience of the work detailed above, aggregators were surveyed by EF, with 27 (out of 44) accredited aggregators responding and reporting an excellent satisfaction rate: 90% of respondents were 'satisfied' and 'completely satisfied' with data space products and services. Cultural heritage institutions were also surveyed, with 419 institutions responding and reporting a good satisfaction rate: 85% of respondents being 'satisfied' and 'completely satisfied'.

We continued to support, maintain and coordinate the frameworks which help to increase the amount of reusable data in the data space, supported by the Data Quality Committee and Copyright Community.

Expand data products and services within the data space

We developed a template for sharing new types of data (datasets) in the data space, working closely with the Datasheets for digital cultural heritage Working Group to ensure that the work is aligned with the Collections as Data workflow. A series of workshops led to the refinement and publication of the datasheet template v. 2. New types of data (datasets) were identified and prioritised for integration into the data space based on reuse potential and we outlined the EDM extensions for datasets (aligning with DCAT) to ensure interoperability. The Data Governance Working Group reviewed governance requirements to support integration.

We also developed the tools and services offering of the data space, focusing on three case studies (MINT, Share3D and Eureka3D Data Hub) to develop both requirements and criteria for providing new services in the data space. This work (similar to the work on datasets) was done with user needs in mind, and therefore we focussed on tools that are critical for the user to share data in the data space.

Automated approaches improving data in the data space

In Y3, we used automatic approaches and AI technologies to address data quality issues at scale. To support metadata-based enrichments, we implemented the Enrichments policy for the data space and updated documentation of these efforts on the Europeana Knowledge Base. We proofed and calibrated problem patterns implemented in the Metis Sandbox to make them more useful for users in their work to assess data's quality and began to assess other patterns for future implementation.

To support content and data-based enrichments, we validated the results of AI experiments carried out in Y2 on watermarks with two different audiences - data providers and users of Europeana.eu. We concluded that there is not yet a clear case for deploying watermark detection technology, but identified meaningful future actions. We also explored using advanced technology for scaling up language detection (used for automatic translation) and updated the language normalisation in Metis to recognise more languages in a consistent way. We also carried out an investigation on applying neural information retrieval to enhance multilingual search, concluding that there are still major challenges to address before we can deploy it in our context.

Alongside these activities, we developed an alignment paper to guide reflection on the use of AI in the data space. We launched an Alignment Assembly on 'Culture for AI' to gather feedback and input from across the sector on the topic, and published a paper mapping the results of the community consultation.

Capacity building and reuse

We work to strengthen the capacity of professionals and reuse communities working with digital cultural heritage. This year, we focused on cultural heritage professionals and new reuse audiences (tourism, media and creatives), collaborating closely with the ENA and EAF to develop training, events and programmes which support reuse of the data, tools and services provided by the data space.

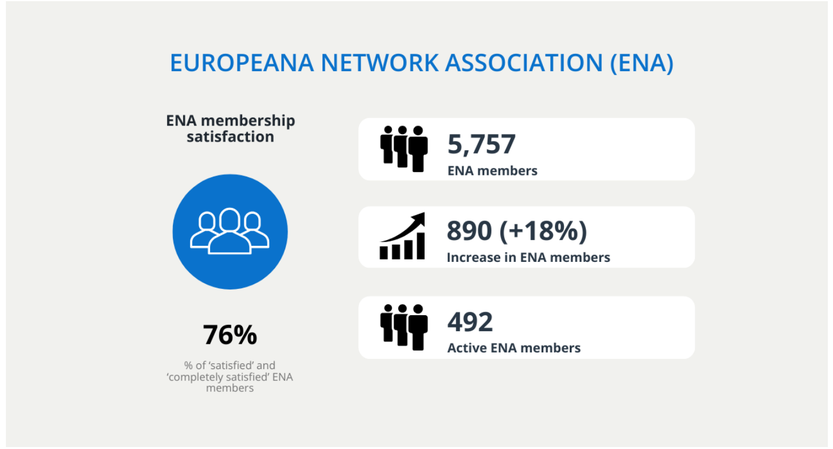
Sustainable development of the data space and its ecosystem

We work towards a sustainable governance model for the Europeana Initiative (EI) as the steward of the data space. In Y3, an EI Task Force conducted a thorough analysis of the EI's current governance model, in particular, the EI's role as the steward of the data space. The Task Force laid the groundwork for a more robust, representative and effective governance model, which is being enacted through a staggered approach. Country groups were established to strengthen national cooperation in Bulgaria, Italy, and Slovenia, and evaluation found that they increased awareness and skill development among professionals, enhanced peer-to-peer learning and cooperation and led to the successful creation of national networks. Based on the recommendations coming from the evaluation a governance structure was developed to better facilitate the work of existing and future Country Groups.

EF continued to provide the secretariat for ENA, supporting its governance boards and communities. The 2024 ENA annual report offers detailed information about network activities, with significant work focused on understanding and engaging with members and effectively communicating the benefits of Membership

to them. Key motivations for joining ENA were analysed and reported, and pilot data for an improved community metrics model were gathered. Ultimately, this led to the enhancement of the ENA membership and community management models.

ENA currently counts over 5,700 members, with 76% of them stating that they are ‘satisfied’ or ‘completely satisfied’ with the ENA (136 responses). In Y3, almost 500 people contributed time and expertise to the Europeana Initiative (being active in TFs, WGs and governance or responding to calls to action to engage with other activities).



Europeana Network Association membership and impact of activities (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. August 2025. CC BY-SA



Europeana 2025 - Preserve, Protect, Reuse by Michał Wandachowicz (NID), CC BY

EF also continued to provide the secretariat for EAF, implementing its enhanced Accreditation Scheme. One new aggregator (Heritage Malta) joined the Forum, while Erfgoedplus left due to inactivity, giving a total of 43 aggregators in the Forum.

In Y3, we further developed a collaborative model to support and engage Member States with the data space. We validated and identified improvements for the Member States' Country Pages in the Metis Statistics Dashboard (which gives Member States insights into their contributions to Europeana.eu and progress towards the targets set by the European Commission's 2021 recommendation on the data space), and we refined and partly implemented a Member States Engagement Strategy for 2024 - 2026. Building on the success of the Twin it! campaign, which was developed in alignment with the Spanish, Swedish and Belgian presidencies of the Council of the EU, and made possible through contributions from all Member States, we planned a follow up thematic campaign, Twin it! Part II, which will span the Polish, Danish and Cypriot presidencies. The campaign, targeted at Member States, will collect more fit-for-purpose, user-focused 3D content in the data space; motivate and support cross-EU collaboration and concerted national efforts; build capacity; and inspire reuse. We delivered and evaluated activities under the Polish Presidency of the council of the EU, with Europeana 2025 in Warsaw being a particular highlight. Finally, we established a concept for a high-influence ambassador network pilot in Finland which we will continue to develop in Y4.

Capacity building as a service

In Y3, we supported individuals and institutions to contribute to - and benefit from - the data space by developing capacity building tools and services, further developing the training platform, and running an inspiring events programme. In collaboration with the ENA and EAF, EF continued to manage the implementation of the Europeana Impact Framework and the Europeana Capacity Building Framework to build capacity throughout the data space. We worked closely with the Europeana Impact and Climate Action communities, the European Students Association for Cultural Heritage, and other initiatives which support skills and capabilities relevant to the data space, nurturing connections that increase its inclusivity and relevance.



Events (including instructor-led training events) (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. Aug 2025. CC-BY-SA

We expanded and delivered our training programme with a focus on aggregators, data providers and users of digital cultural heritage. A particular highlight was the launch of the Europeana Academy, consisting of self-paced and instructor-led training on topics from storytelling to IIIF to copyright. In total, in Y3, we organised 18 instructor-led training sessions, which reached 250 participants with an excellent satisfaction rate of 92%. We made 19 courses (16 English, two Italian and one French) available through the online platform (self-paced training), which saw 1,375 enrollments with a high satisfaction of 87%.

In Y3, EF, EAF and ENA ran an inspiring programme of 40 events, welcoming almost 4,400 participants. 92% of those who responded to post-event surveys reported being 'satisfied' and 'completely satisfied' with the events, reflecting their high-quality organisation and delivery. One particular highlight was Europeana 2025 - Preserve, Protect, Reuse, organised under the patronage of the Polish Presidency of the Council of the EU. Over 600 people attended the conference, with 275 in-person participants joining from 33 countries (from 65 countries online). Another highlight was the European Heritage Hub Forum: Championing a responsible digital transition for and with cultural heritage. Led by EF as the project's digital expertise partner, the hybrid Forum welcomed over 400 participants to explore the digital dimension of heritage preservation and the role of heritage for social and environmental transformation.

Approach to drive reuse of data space products and services

Together with EAF and ENA, we defined the methodology behind use cases and use case scenarios. We created a template and methodology for collecting use cases and requirements for product and service development across the EI and data space. The template allows data space participants to submit their own use cases for inclusion in the data space, and can be used to submit a dataset or request a third party tool or service to be included in the data space. A dataset-specific template was tested with the Datasheets Working Group, and fed into the collection of further use cases and requirements for the data space from our consortium, supporting the sustainable model for reuse in the data space. This model enables us to verify that the data space offerings meet the needs of target audiences through the documentation and collection of validated (and measured) use cases.

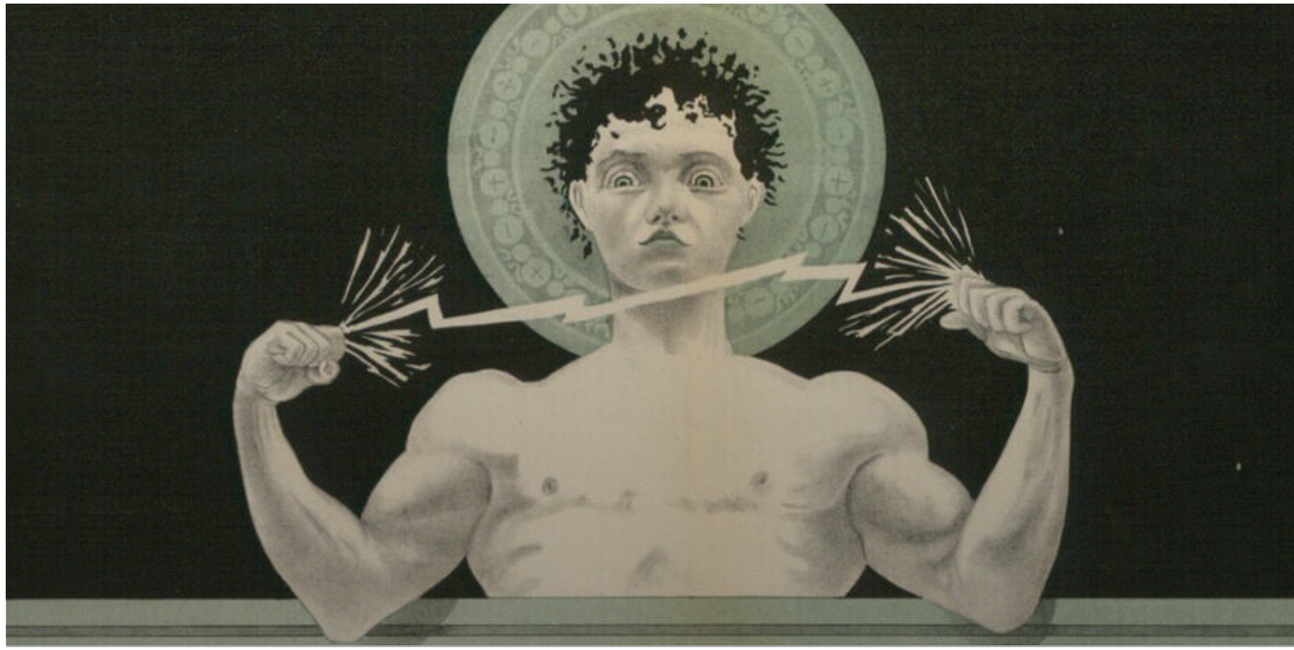
Facilitate the reuse of data space products and services

By providing tools and services to increase data quality, enrichment and reuse, we engaged cultural heritage professionals, researchers, educators, tourism, media and creative audiences with the data space and supported reuse through our APIs.

To support our work with cultural heritage institutions, we developed eight personas which capture the individual roles of four different cultural heritage areas across a variety of institutions. Each persona had a corresponding value proposition page showing how the products (or potential products and services) provided by the data space should be included in an offer for them, and what gains they provide, or pains they relieve. This will help us to shape our offer in the future. We also developed our CHI engagement workflows, improving and analysing the sign-ups coming through the Share Your Collections Page to inform next steps for interacting with these institutions, such as changing elements of the sign-up form, working closely with EAF on the process, and refining email communications and workflows.

To engage with educational communities (including educators and students), we worked with EUN and EuroClio to raise digital skills and capacity and increase use of educational resources which use data shared via Europeana.eu. In Y3, EUN and Euroclio 'trained' a total of 3,250 people via online courses and national training in how to use Europeana.eu. Beside others, activities resulted in the creation of newly created resources with data shared through Europeana.eu which were or will be published on the Teaching with Europeana blog and Historiana. Educators reported a very good satisfaction rate of 89%. Work was enhanced by the Europeana Education Community.

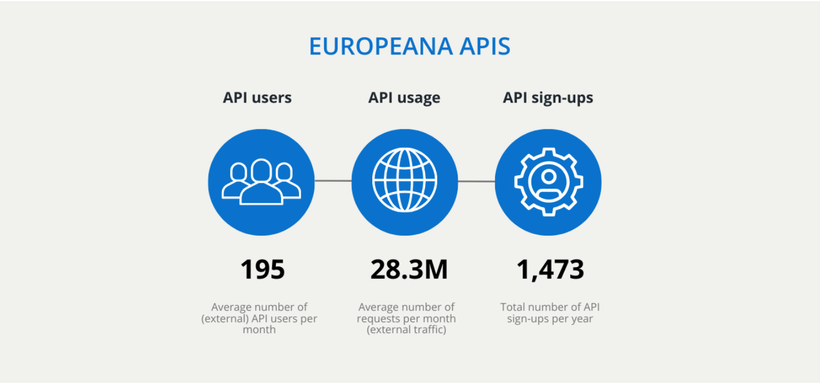
A particular highlight of work with educational communities was the fourth edition of Built with Bits, an international online experience where participants learn how to design virtual environments which address local issues through digital culture and education. This year, 20 participants contributed to the creation of nine scenarios reusing digital cultural heritage. Another highlight was EuroClio's Creating Lessons with Europeana initiative, which saw six educators from five countries join a co-creation session in the Hague to learn how to reuse content from Europeana.eu to create digital classroom activities. Following the residency, each educator leader hosted national workshops to introduce their newly developed eLearning resources to at least 20 fellow educators, expanding the reach and impact of Historiana. Finally, as part of the Scientix Cultural Legacy Awards run by EUN, educators in formal and non-formal education submitted 152 valid (out of 249) Stories of Implementation that demonstrated effective use of Europeana resources. Award winners were invited to participate in the 2025 Science Projects Workshop in Brussels, organised by EUN.



ELECTRISCHE KRAFTVERMIETHUNG; WIEN, RUDOLFSHEIM, PFEIFFERGASSE 3, Albertina, Austria, Public Domain.

We worked with academic and research communities to encourage their reuse of cultural heritage data and engagement with the data space. We supported and collaborated with the Europeana Research Community as well as other communities of professionals interested in digital scholarship. One particular event highlight was a series of webinars on data reuse for Higher Education and Research, which we organised in collaboration with DARIAH and ENA in conjunction with the start of the academic year. Over 400 people registered for the webinars, which demonstrated and strengthened our commitment to empowering academia professionals and university students with the knowledge and tools to reuse cultural heritage data. The webinars contributed to attracting users to the Europeana website, a high number of sign-ups for an API key, interest in the DARIAH Campus resources on digital cultural heritage developed within the data space. Other highlights were a series of workshops to test the 'Collections as Data' workflow to curate datasets in the data space setting and expand related documentation, through the refinement of a datasheet template. Progress with this work was presented in the scientific article: A workflow to publish Collections as Data: looking back at Europeana.eu and forward to the common European data space for cultural heritage (Candela, G., at alii, Transformations: A DARIAH Journal).

To engage with developer communities and API customers, our outreach in Y3 focused on creating more awareness of Europeana's APIs as a valuable development tool in digital cultural heritage, and promoting the capacity building resources and documentation sources developed throughout Y2. We promoted the Europeana API suite and improved our relationship with API users in a number of different ways: we enhanced customer support; ensured differentiation between users and customers via the introduction of project keys; developed a new onboarding workflow for requesting, reviewing and accepting project keys; and designed an add-on marketing workflow for API personal keys users, focusing on offering them an upgrade to a project key once we observe signs of substantial API usage. We continued to maintain and update our API documentation and capacity building resources, leveraging the Europeana Academy API training to support users. In Y3, the Europeana REST API (which includes Europeana's main APIs allowing users to build applications with our collections) had on average 195 users a month and almost 28.3 million requests per month. In Y3, we saw a significant increase in API use, compared to Y2, with 32% more users a month (148 avg. users a month in Y2) and 66.5% more requests per month (17 million avg. requests a month in Y2). We also saw an 68.5% increase in API sign-ups, compared to Y2.



Usage of Europeana REST API (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. August 2025. CC BY-SA

We also undertook renewed efforts to engage with tourism, media and creative (in particular writers) communities. To start this work and help us implement activities with cross-audience potential, we measured which audiences we reached and the efforts required using our audience and activity mapping matrix, which is based on our Lead / Participate / Enable engagement model. We developed our offer for tourists, and also for CHIs and tourism destinations looking to promote their offer to tourists, through

products like walking tours and creative postcard workshops; collaborated with the data space for tourism through DEPLOYTOUR; supported the Communicators Community to run a series of webinars focused on cultural heritage and tourism; and increased our presence at national-level and European-level tourism events. We engaged with a media audience through collaboration with the Media data space (TEMS) on trial 8 (Market and co-creation place for 3D environments for virtual production), offering our data for their 3D marketplace MVP which is in development. We organised a webinar series highlighting the reuse possibilities of AV heritage and the value of cultural heritage data to various media professionals. We developed our outreach to creative (in particular writers) communities through events, representation at international conferences and resources like the Europeana story dice.

Build awareness and engagement

We built awareness of, and engagement with, data space activities among professional audiences through a strategic approach to marketing and communications, a joined-up approach for key channels, clear and consistent organisational narratives and insights gathered from user research and ongoing evaluation. In Y3, we updated and implemented approaches to social media and email marketing and published regular, inspiring content through Europeana Pro. Activities were promoted across social media and newsletters, supported by the Europeana Communicators Community.

We structured and managed knowledge and resources through the data space, giving audiences clarity about where information sits, and ensuring that content is clear and of high quality. Focusing principally on Europeana Pro, the data space landing page, the Knowledge Base and the Training Platform, this included delivering a strategy for platforms for professional audiences and an editorial strategy which seeks to make user journeys clear and consistent and deliver high-quality content for audiences.

We also took targeted actions on different platforms. We prepared for the launch of a minimal viable product (MVP) of the data space website, which presents the offer of the common European data space for cultural heritage and encourages audiences to engage with it. The data space website will be available in 24 European languages, made possible through the use of the eTranslation service, which editors can use to automatically translate the website's content. This will ensure that visitors can interact with the website in their own language, making it more accessible and user-friendly.

The Knowledge Base was in use over the past year, making available training resources and documentation. In Y3, the KB saw almost 13,600 visits.

We progressed with the migration of content from Europeana Pro to other platforms, working to a detailed plan delivered in Y3. We ensured that, while still live, Pro provided a good experience for its users. In Y3, Europeana Pro saw over 230,000 visits, and 81% of users reported being 'satisfied' or 'completely satisfied' with the website.

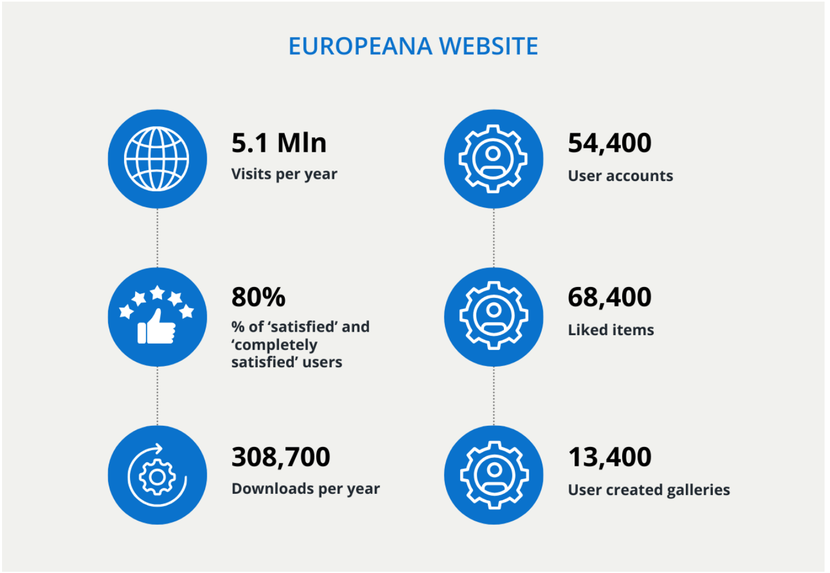
Digital services for the public

The Europeana website is the main product of the data space, and in Y3, we continued to improve its functionalities, add new features and explore how we can better serve existing and potential audiences. We expanded the website's pan-European themes and perspectives, inspiring use, reuse and participation.

High-performing Europeana website

Europeana.eu offers pan-European content of over 60 million to anyone with an interest in cultural heritage. In Y3, the website received almost 5.1 million visits, with 80% of users stating they are 'satisfied' or 'completely satisfied' with the website. The website interface and static pages are maintained in 25 European languages (the 24 official EU languages and Basque). Despite the decrease in traffic for Y3 (-15%), we see an increase in engagement that resulted in a stable number of downloads, a substantial increase of 41% more user accounts on Europeana.eu, 47% more liked items, and 31% more user created galleries. This is in line with our effort to increase reuse of cultural heritage content.

There were many development highlights for Europeana.eu in Y3. Alongside ongoing work to optimise search and browse experience to improve content discovery, we expanded multilingual coverage of Europeana.eu. We updated the language detection functionality in our Translation API by expanding it with a hybrid solution using a combination of Google (for short text) and Apache Tika (for longer text). This reduces dependency on Google, improving quality, performance and reducing costs. This supported the expansion of multilingual search beyond the Spanish portal and the deployment of multilingual search in more languages - Hungarian, Polish and Romanian. Users can choose whether to use the feature and switch it on and off.



Satisfaction and usage of the Europeana website (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. Aug 2025. CC BY-SA

We also extended user curation features, in particular, the entity flow curation. We made a clearer distinction between organisations that are aggregators versus data partners, making the relationship explicit in the metadata so that users can understand which institutions aggregators work with. Metadata for aggregators was expanded to explain what services they provide and their scope. By making institutional

connections more visible, we aim to encourage aggregators to invest resources in curating and promoting both their own and their data partners' organisation pages on Europeana.eu.

Additionally, we developed a new API that allows users to see public and published Galleries made in Europeana.eu as IIIF collections. This allows users to explore and reuse galleries outside of Europeana.eu and potentially integrate them in other websites and services, or use them in tools running locally to the user.

We optimised user interaction and display of content, making further improvements to the media viewer for images and text media. We implemented a new approach that gives us more flexibility to select the features we want to display, which makes it easier to further develop and maintain the media viewer. We also implemented the embedded media notification which is visible on all embedded media on the website. This notification notifies users that this is embedded media from a third-party website and that by interacting with it they are agreeing to the privacy policy of the third-party platform. This ensures compliance with GDPR.

Engage audiences with digital cultural heritage

By showcasing inspiring examples of digital storytelling and reuse, we encouraged the public to reuse cultural heritage and promoted the data space as a vast source of open access heritage data. Through multilingual, curated editorial on pan-European themes and innovative engagement campaigns, we fostered digital skills and participation.

In total, 58 new editorials were published in Y3: 55 blogs and 3 exhibitions. Overall, users were very satisfied with the stories (blogs and exhibitions) published, with 84% on average being 'satisfied' or 'completely satisfied'. In total, exhibitions and blogs published on the Europeana website received almost 1.1 million visits in the past year. We expanded multilingual access to editorial content by increasing the amount of



Satisfaction, multilingual coverage, and visits to editorial on the Europeana website (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. August 2025. CC BY-SA

content that is accessible in each of 24 EU languages. In Y3, 91% of stories (blogs and exhibitions) were published in more than one language (52 stories), including almost 14% of stories which were published in all EU languages (8 stories). We also published stories of reuse showcasing the work of creative reusers (see an example).

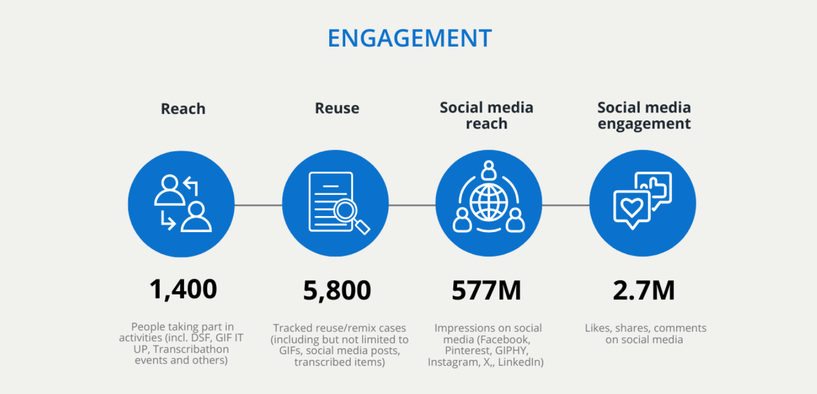
We engaged audiences through innovative events like our GIF IT UP contest in October, where contestants remix openly licensed digital cultural heritage in GIF formats. The 2024 contest attracted 114 eligible entries, marking a 16% increase compared to 2023. Participants from 19 different nations creatively remixed over 150 cultural heritage items sourced from 51 cultural institutions across 23 countries. Around 30% of participants were young people, with two more schools participating on top of the returning class from Liepaja. We published a guided tutorial in 24 languages to help participants learn GIF-making techniques, alongside tutorials on other topics such as Six ways to play with Europeana Story Dice. For Black History Month, we organised a creative reuse activity with artist Lela Harris which resulted in reuse examples. This was part of our wider pan-European thematic seasons for Black History Month, including multilingual editorial on Europeana.eu and news on Europeana Pro. For Women's History Month, we organised an online collage prompt challenge with Paris Collage Collective resulting in more than 330 collages created virtually and an in-person event organised in Paris on International Women's Day.

Another highlight was the fifth edition of the Digital Storytelling Festival and its associated Online Creative Residency. The Festival brought together cultural heritage professionals, educators, creatives, policymakers and students to develop storytelling and digital skills while exploring cultural heritage and themes important for contemporary society. Over 1,200 people registered for the Festival with 566 attendees reporting a 86% satisfaction based on 191 responses. The Residency saw participants develop creative projects reusing material from Europeana.eu in different digital formats. This year's edition had 18 creative reuse projects in seven different formats.

EF showcased and promoted inspiring examples of digital storytelling and content reuse and promoted the data space as a treasure trove of open access heritage data. In total almost 1,400 participants took part in user engagement activities (incl. DSF, GIF IT UP, Transcribathon events and others) and we recorded over 5,800 reuse/remix cases (including but not limited to GIFs, social media posts, transcribed items).

Audiences were reached through channels including Facebook, Pinterest, Instagram, LinkedIn and GIPHY. In Jan 2025, we started using Bluesky, to offer our followers an alternative to X. In Y3, we saw high social media performance with almost 577 million impressions on social media and high engagement with almost 2.7 million likes, shares, comments.

The EF 2024 Advent calendar enjoyed its usual popularity promoting activities created with open access data. This year, short videos showcased creative activities encouraging reuse and were published daily on Instagram, Youtube Shorts and Pinterest.



Engagement metrics for activities that promote the reuse of cultural heritage and social media (Sep 2024 - Aug 2025). Europeana Foundation. August 2025. CC BY-SA

Data space supporting projects

EF contributes to data space supporting projects with the ingestion of content and metadata, the implementation of relevant Europeana frameworks, policy and development guidelines, the integration of tools into the Europeana website, capacity building activities and dissemination of project results. Below is an overview of projects running and completed in Y3:

DIGITAL-2022-CULTURAL-02 call:

DE-BIAS - Detecting and cur(at)ing harmful language in cultural heritage collections

EUreka3D - European Union's REKonstructed content in 3D (1 Jan 2023 - 31 Dec 2024)

5Dculture - Deploying and demonstrating a 3D cultural heritage space (1 Jan 2023 - 31 Dec 2024)

AI4Culture - An AI platform for the cultural heritage data space (1 Apr 2023 - 31 Mar 2025)

DIGITAL-2023-CLOUD-DATA-AI-05-CULTHERITAGE call:

XRCulture - Enriching the data space with high-quality 3D models, leveraging innovative AI-based digitisation methods and novel Extended Reality (XR) applications

3DBigDataSpace - Increasing high-quality 3D content in the data space and establishing Europe-wide, stable, long-term storage solutions for 3D models

EUreka3D-XR - Enhancing 3D and XR scenarios in the data space and offering tools and resources for cultural institutions to create immersive experiences

A short summary of key results from the data space supporting projects completed during the year is included on the next page.

DE-BIAS promoted a more inclusive and respectful approach to describing cultural heritage. The project developed the DE-BIAS Tool, which detects outdated and potentially harmful language in descriptions of cultural heritage collections. The tool is available as a standalone application accessible via a web interface and as an API endpoint allowing users to connect to the tool in the context of their own workflows and systems. The API endpoint has also been integrated into the Metis Sandbox and can as such be used when preparing data for submission to Europeana.eu. The DE-BIAS Tool highlights and explains the biased terms that appear in an item's metadata. This iteration focused on biased terms in German, French and English. View this item page on the German locale and hover over the DeBias project logo next to the title to see the text explaining the biased term.

EUreka3D built the capacity of small cultural heritage institutions in digital transformation, particularly on issues related to 3D digitisation, and set the stage for the EUreka3D-XR project which started in February. The project developed the EUreka3D Data Hub, a knowledge, service and resource hub based on a smart technical infrastructure to act as a competence centre for 3D in the European data space for cultural heritage.

5Dulture enriched the offer of 3D digital cultural heritage assets in the common European data space for cultural heritage and fostered their reuse in domains such as education, tourism and the wider cultural and creative sector. The project developed the 5Dculture Community of Practice, which is a dedicated platform showcasing tools, resources and best practices to facilitate the sharing and reuse of 3D content.

AI4Culture developed the AI4Culture Platform, an online capacity building hub for the application of artificial intelligence technologies in the cultural heritage sector. It offers access to a pool of AI-related resources, a set of deployable and reusable tools and capacity building materials. Components are interoperable with the data space to facilitate data sharing and reusability of cultural content as well as strengthen the connection between the data space and cultural heritage institutions.

Budget and realisation

The third year as a common European data space for cultural heritage was funded for €7.5 million, and distributed amongst 19 partners (period from 1 September 2024 to 31 August 2025). The work was performed in five separate work packages:

1. Development and operation of the data space infrastructure
2. Integration of high-quality data
3. Capacity building and fostering reuse
4. Digital services for the public
5. Programme management

The balance of efforts table states foreseen and actual percentages of resources allocated to each of the five work packages and its related tasks.

Work packages & tasks	Foreseen %	Actual Aug 2025
WP 1: Development and operation of the data space infrastructure	**25.9%**	**25.8%**
Task 1.1 Provide reliable data space infrastructure and quality of services	22.7%	19.6%
Task 1.2 Develop and ensure interoperability with the broader ecosystem of cultural heritage initiatives	5,8%	6.2%
WP 2: Integration of high-quality data	**15.4%**	**15.1%**
Task 2.1 Increase the availability of reusable data in line with the Recommendations 2021	7.9%	8.5%
Task 2.2 Expand data products and services within the data space	3.7%	3.9%
Task 2.3 Deploy automated approaches improving the quality and reusability of data in the data space	3.8%	2.7%
WP 3: Capacity building and fostering reuse	**34.3%**	**34.2%**
Task 3.1 Nurture the sustainable development of the data space and its ecosystem	7.0%	6.2%
Task 3.2 Develop capacity building as a service	6.0%	6.6%
Task 3.3 Develop approach to drive reuse of data space products and services	6.6%	6.6%
Task 3.4 Facilitate the reuse of data space products and services	10.2%	10.4%
Task 3.5 Build awareness and engagement	4.5%	4.4%
WP 4: Digital services for the public	**18.8%**	**18.9%**
Task 4.1 Deliver high-performing Europeana website	12.6%	12.1%
Task 4.2 Engage audiences with digital cultural heritage	6.2%	6.8%
WP 5: Programme management	**5.6%**	**6.0%**
Task 5.1 Ensure continuous progress monitoring and reporting	3.1%	4.2%
Task 5.2 Governance	0.7%	1.0%
Task 5.3 Manage relations with other EU-funded projects	1.6%	0.8%
Task 5.4 Phasing-in and phasing-out periods	0.2%	0.0%
Total	**100%**	**100%**

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